Alexander Key

Senior Full-Stack Rails Developer

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Senior Ruby on Rails developer with 10 years shipping and operating production Rails applications end to end, from architecture, Stripe payments, and Hotwire front ends to PostgreSQL and the Linux servers and CI/CD pipelines behind them. Led small teams through three ground-up rebuilds of legacy platforms onto modern Rails, most recently a Rails 3 to Rails 8 rewrite.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer — Reservation Genie, Austin, TX 2023 – Present

- Rebuilt a legacy Rails 3 reservation platform from greenfield on Ruby on Rails 8, PostgreSQL, and Hotwire, leading a small team to deliver reservations, rentals, private charters, and digital waivers at 50,000+ reservations a year.
- Built the payment system behind every booking on Stripe Connect (connected accounts, platform fees, webhooks, refunds) plus an ActiveMerchant gateway layer that lets clients bring their own payment processor, processing ~$5M a year in payment volume.
- Increased client reservations 30% by launching white-labeled booking subdomains (e.g. book.clientdomain.com) with host-aware routing and cookie scoping, so UTM and Google Ads attribution survives from the client's site through purchase and clients can see which channels convert.

Senior Software Engineer — Tally Meals, Austin, TX 2022 – 2023

- Replaced a failing legacy PHP API and React Native platform for Greek house meal management by leading a small team through a ground-up Ruby on Rails rebuild, owning architecture, servers, and CI/CD from first commit to a launch serving 100+ houses across 35+ universities.
- Shipped iOS and Android apps from a single Rails codebase using Hotwire Native, letting members reserve meals and late plates against chef-published menus with per-member allergy and dietary tracking, meal-plan limits and billing compliance, and printable kitchen prep lists.
- Carried every client's historical data through the replatform by converting the legacy database to PostgreSQL, reverse-engineering the old schema and migrating chapters, members, meal plans, and reservation history into the new Rails domain model.

88 Restaurants — Austin, TX 2018 – 2022

Senior Full-Stack Developer 2021 – 2022

Junior Full-Stack Developer 2018 – 2021

- Split the restaurant product out of a shared legacy Rails codebase into a greenfield multi-tenant platform spanning online ordering, reservations, live table management, loyalty, and marketing automation, leading a small team and personally authoring 4,400+ commits across 280K lines of application code, a 140-table MySQL schema, and a 359-file RSpec suite, owning the stack from schema design to production servers.
- Processed 8 figures in payment volume by architecting the online ordering system end to end: Stripe checkout and refunds, Stripe Connect onboarding so restaurants are paid directly, Uber Direct delivery integration, order scheduling, gift cards and ticketed events, and a full catering system.
- Delivered the platform's most complex feature, live table management, by building real-time table-state synchronization across every device in the restaurant with ActionCable WebSockets, a drag-and-drop floor-plan editor, and an availability engine, giving front-of-house staff a single live view of the floor.

Junior Full-Stack Developer — Austin City Guide, Austin, TX 2016 – 2018

- Achieved #1 Google rankings for competitive local keywords like "things to do in Austin" through on-page SEO, technical optimization, and page-speed work in a Rails rebuild of the legacy .NET site.
- Built in-house analytics in Rails to measure real user behavior across the site's highest-traffic pages.
- Increased click-through rates on the highest-traffic pages with an A/B split-testing system in Rails that tested page layouts against live traffic.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — Texas State University, San Marcos, TX

Skills

Back End: Ruby, Ruby on Rails (3 – 8), Active Record, Active Job, ActionCable, Action Mailer, Active Merchant, Stripe, RSpec, Sidekiq, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, REST APIs, Twilio, Postmark, Uber Direct

Front End: Hotwire (Turbo & Stimulus), Hotwire Native (iOS & Android), JavaScript, TailwindCSS, Bootstrap

Infrastructure: Linux, Kamal, Dokku, Nginx, GitHub Actions